Diamante Technical Coaching

DevOpsDays Raleigh · 2026

Your Teams Need Learning Time Not More AI Tools

Steven Diamante

Founder · Technical Coach · Diamante Technical Coaching

Who am I?

- **Steven Diamante from Raleigh, NC**
  - Founder of Diamante Technical Coaching
- **Avid XP practitioner**
  - pairing
  - TDD
  - refactoring
  - continuous integration
- **Over 1500 hours of Claude Code usage**
  - Building high-quality apps in production
- **Hobbies**
  - Plays guitar and sings
  - Meditating for over 5 years
  - Chess and Poker
  - Travels the world with family

YOU'VE SEEN THIS MOVIE

"We need the AI."

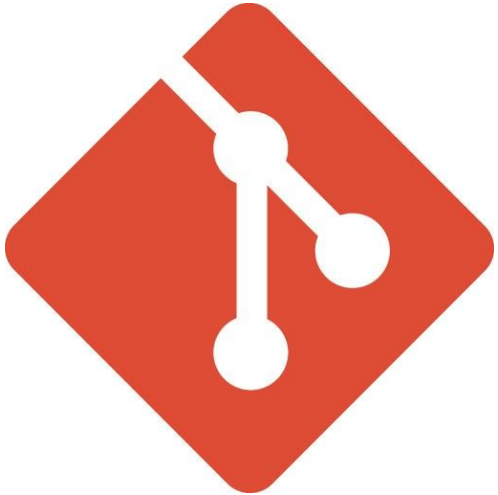
Licenses go out. Onboarding is minimal. Standards don't exist. Reviews pile up. Bug rates climb. Merge hell. Leadership did not buy this.

PART 01 OF 03

The productivity paradox.

It feels faster. The numbers say otherwise.

Batches were already too big. AI makes them bigger.



WHAT I ADVOCATE FOR ON EVERY TEAM

Synchronous code review.

01 Reviewer checks it out and runs it locally. Tests it like QA.

02 Reviewer asks about names, intent, edge cases, out loud.

03 When the author says “I don't know, AI wrote it,” you sit and work out what the code does.

04 Fix issues in real time

If you can't explain it, you don't merge it.

More code shipped. Less code understood.

+242%
Incidents per PR

+441%
Median PR review time

+31%
PRs merged with no review

FAROS AI · 22,000 DEVELOPERS · 2026 · "ACCELERATION WHIPLASH"

"

AI doesn't fix a team. It amplifies what's already there.

DORA · STATE OF DEVOPS 2025 · "A MIRROR AND A MULTIPLIER"

PART 02 OF 03

Three adoption patterns.

Poor → better → best.

PATTERN 01

"We have AI, now use it."

Licenses deployed. Workflows unchanged. Everyone stays solo. Adoption counted as success.

6 MONTHS LATER

Nothing moves.

PATTERN 02

Volunteer demos, siloed work.

A senior runs bi-weekly demos. Good ideas surface, then evaporate. The work itself is still solo.

6 MONTHS LATER

Champion burns out.

PATTERN 03

Social programming on real code.

Pairing and ensemble sessions in production code with agents in the loop. Workflows spread by active engagement and experimentation.

6 MONTHS LATER

It compounds.

PATTERN 01 · POOR

"We have AI. Now use it."

Leadership bought licenses. The box is checked. The team's operating model is untouched.

01 No onboarding, no standards, no shared rituals.

02 Agent bolted onto yesterday's workflow.

03 Dashboards celebrate seat count.

04 Downstream signals do not move. Not quality. Not throughput. Not morale.

6 MONTHS LATER → NO IMPROVEMENT

CONDITIONS GET WORSE DUE TO ACCELERATION WHIPLASH

Most orgs are here today

PATTERN 02 · BETTER

Volunteer demos, siloed delivery.

A motivated senior starts a bi-weekly AI demo slot. Good intentions. Wrong altitude.

01 Knowledge lives in the room for an hour, then evaporates.

02 The work itself is still solo, still hidden in branches.

03 Attendance is opt-in, so learning is opt-in.

04 The volunteer senior burns out first.

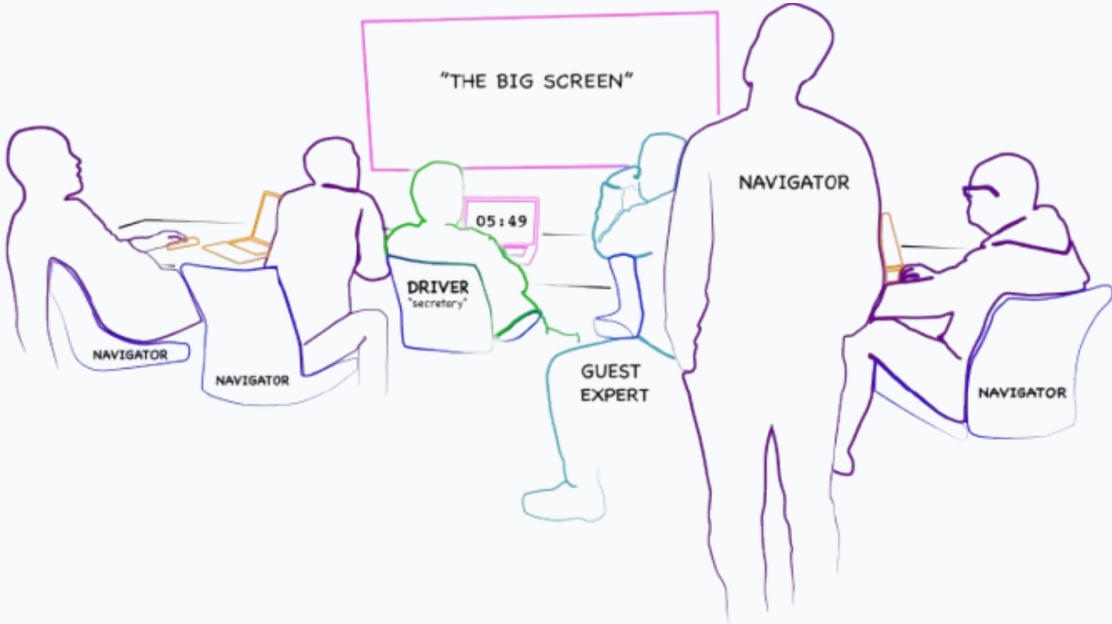
6 MONTHS LATER → AI CHAMPION BURNS OUT

THE SERIES QUIETLY ENDS.

Better than nothing. Still not enough.

AI EN·SEM·BLE *noun, practice*

"All the brilliant minds, working on the same thing, at the same time, in the same space , on the same computer. With AI as a full participant."



COLAB AI · MAARET PYHÄJÄRVI & CO. · 2025

PATTERN 03 · BEST

Social programming on real code.

Pairing. Ensembles. Agents in the loop. Review becomes the work. Code reviews disappear.

01 Same problem, same time, shared keyboard.

02 Review happens live, not three days later in a PR.

03 Seniors coach by doing, not documenting.

04 Good prompts, skills, and context get captured as they're discovered.

> 6 MONTHS LATER → PRACTICES SPREAD.
>
> LEARNING STICKS. EVERY WEEK BUILDS ON THE LAST.

This is the pattern that compounds

ONE CONDITION. NON-NEGOTIABLE.

AI ensemble only works with guardrails.

- Rigorous automated tests
- Linters
- Type checks
- Merciless refactoring

Without guardrails, the code gets less reliable every session.
With them, the team gets sharper every session

When everyone works solo, one person becomes the bottleneck

10+ hrs

PER WEEK · SENIOR TIME ON AI-PR CLEANUP

Junior ships AI code. Senior reviews it three days later. Context is gone. Mistakes have compounded.

Pairing cuts this in half. Immediately. Because review becomes the work, not a queue behind it.

PART 03 OF 03

What changes when teams learn together.

A client story → the one practice → how to diagnose your team.

From Scrum silos to an agent skills marketplace.

TWO MONTHS · 2 TO 3 TEAMS A WEEK · LEAN COFFEES + WORKING SESSIONS ON REAL TICKETS.

BEFORE

MONTH 0

Solo devs, standups only.

Classic Scrum cadence. Work happened in isolation. Ideas stayed on the person who had them.

KNOWLEDGE MOVES AT SPRINT-REVIEW SPEED

→

AFTER

MONTH 2

Collaboration in every form. Skills shared across teams.

Ensembling in working sessions. Social programming between them, team by team. Agent skills published to a shared internal marketplace.

ONE PERSON'S AGENT LEARNS → EVERY AGENT LEARNS

That org now calls itself AI-first. Not from licenses. From collaboration.

THE ONE THING · IF YOU TAKE NOTHING ELSE

2 hours a week. Hands on the keyboard. Agent in the loop. Real code.

01 Demo a new open-source agentic tool you've been trying.

02 Demo a new skill or subagent you built this week.

03 Work a real ticket together. So much learning and KT from this.

04 Create shared skills as a team. Everyone's agent benefits.

So which pattern is your team in?

Answer each honestly. The side you land on tells you where you are.

01 How do our agents behave across the team?

EVERYONE FREESTYLES → P01 / P02
No shared rules, prompts, or skills.

SHARED STANDARDS → P03
One shared playbook. Picked up by working together.

02 When one person finds a great workflow, what happens?

DIES AT THEIR DESK · OR DEMOED & FORGOTTEN → P01 / P02
Slack post nobody reads, or a brown bag that never gets adopted.

SPREADS BY PAIRING → P03
Captured as a shared skill. In use by tomorrow.

03 Where is your senior bandwidth going?

CLEANING UP AI PRs → P01 / P02
10+ hrs/week reviewing and fixing code they didn't write.

TEACHING LIVE → P03
Coaching happens in pairs and ensembles, not in PR review.

Diamante Technical Coaching

Put recurring learning time on the calendar.

Two hours. Protected. Every week.

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Slides